Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam

MGU-UGP (Honours)

Fifth Semester Examination

(2024 Admission Onwards)

MG5DSEENG307– PARTITION LITERATURE

Duration: 2 hrs Maximum Marks: 70

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Learning Domains	***Remember (R), Understand (U), Apply (A), Analyse (An)***

PART A

Multiple Choice Questions

Answer **All** Questions

Each question carries **1** mark

1. What does the concept of "agency" imply in distinguishing partition from secession?
   A. It identifies who undertakes the political action
   B. It determines the geographical size of a territory.
   C. It refers to the economic strength of a state.
   D. It determines the cultural identity of a population [U] [CO1]

2. What is the central concern of Parvinder Mehta's essay?
   A. The political causes of the Partition of India
   B. Female silence and women interventions in Partition discourse
   C. The economic consequences of Partition
   D. The role of political leaders in Partition [U] [CO1]

3. According to the poet, the image of barbed wire in the poem "Broken Bengal" is _____.
   A. a natural boundary
   B. a symbol of freedom
   C. a man-made barrier
   D. an agricultural fence [U] [CO2]

4. The expression 'our two countries' in the poem "Karachi" refers to _____.
   A. India and Nepal
   B. India and Bangladesh
   C. India and Pakistan
   D. Pakistan and Afghanistan [R] [CO2]

5. What does the speaker compare his lament to in the final section of the poem “The Country Without a Post Office”?
   A. Birds flying home
   B. Falling leaves
   C. Dead letters sent across the world
   D. Flowing rivers [U] [CO2]

6. The partition that Sujatha Bhat mentions in her poem is between:
   A. India and West Bengal
   B. India and Afghanistan
   C. India and Pakistan
   D. Bhutan and China. [R] [CO2]

7. According to the poem 'I Say Unto Waris Shah', what has happened to the "five rivers"
   A. They have dried up
   B. Someone has poured poison into them
   C. They have changed their course
   D. They have stopped flowing [R] [CO2]

8. Which newspaper does the Muslim lunatic read in the asylum?
   A. Dawn
   B. Zamindar
   C. Hindustan Times
   D. Tribune [R] [CO3]

9. Who finds the lost child Pali?
   A. A police officer
   B. Shakur Ahmed, a chinaware seller
   C. The maulvi of the mosque
   D. A social worker [R] [CO3]

10. Identify the profession of Khushwant Singh before becoming a full-time writer.
   A. Lawyer and diplomat
   B. Doctor
   C. Army officer
   D. School teacher [R] [CO4]

(1 X 10= 30)

PART B

Short Answer Questions (100 Words)
Answer any **6** Questions
Each question carries **5** marks

11. Compare internal and external partitions in terms of their effects on territorial boundaries and political jurisdictions, as reflected in the essay by Brendan O' Leary. [An] [CO1]

12. Critically examine Parvinder Mehta's argument that female silence can function as a form of discursive intervention in representations of the Partition. [An] [CO1]

13. Discuss the significance of the comparison between 'your city' and 'my city' in the poem "Karachi". [A] [CO2]

14. Analyse the significance of silence as a recurring motif in the poem "The Country Without a Post Office". [An] [CO2]

15. Examine the theme of regret as expressed in the poem "Partition". [A] [CO2]

16. The speaker in 'I Say Unto Waris Shah' states that "blood rained on the earth, / it seeped through the graves." How does this image connect burial, violence, and the violation of sacred or ancestral space? [A] [CO3]

17. Describe the circumstances under which Pali gets separated from his parents during the partition migration. [An] [CO3]

18. Analyze M.S. Sathyu's directorial choice to set the film "Garm Hawa" 25 years after Partition rather than during the event itself. [An] [CO3]

19. Illustrate the role of Hukum Chand as a representative of the colonial administration during crisis. [An] [CO4]

(6 X 5= 30)

PART C

Essay Questions (300 Words)

Answer any **2** Questions

Each question carries 1**5** marks

20. Critically examine Parvinder Mehta's argument that female silence can f form of discursive intervention in representations of the Partition. [An] [CO1]

21. Analyse how the poem "Broken Bengal" presents Partition not merely as a political event but as a humanitarian tragedy. [An] [CO2]

22. Analyze the Sikh lunatic's comment in "Toba Tek Singh" about not knowing the language of "Hindostonis" and the response that follows. What does this exchange reveal about communal stereotypes and the absurdity of nationalist division? [An] [CO3]

23. Articulate whether “Train to Pakistan” is a historical novel, a political novel or a humanist novel. Justify your answer. [A] [CO4]

(15 X 2= 30)